

Assessment Answer Key

Author: Rauf Shah, MS, Ph.D., MPH-EPI Student, CPH-UNMC
Lead Health data Coordinator Level II, Lymphoma Study Group, UNMC

Part 1: Multiple Choice (with questions)

- 1) The primary purpose of age-adjusting incidence rates is to:
- a) Make rates easier to calculate
 - b) Allow fair comparisons between populations with different age structures
 - c) Reduce the reported number of cases
 - d) Protect elderly patient privacy

Answer: b

- 2) Which surveillance type is characterized by registry staff proactively seeking case information?
- a) Passive Surveillance
 - b) Syndromic Surveillance
 - c) Active Surveillance
 - d) Sentinel Surveillance

Answer: c

- 3) The definitive standard for cancer registry data field definitions is found in:
- a) AJCC Cancer Staging Manual
 - b) ICD-O-3 Topography codes
 - c) NAACCR Volume II Data Dictionary
 - d) SEER Summary Stage guidelines

Answer: c

- 4) Small-cell suppression in public reporting typically protects counts below:
- a) 50 cases
 - b) 20 cases
 - c) 10 cases
 - d) 5 cases

Answer: d

- 5) Relative survival calculation compares observed survival to:
- a) Patients with different cancer types

- b) Healthy volunteers
- c) Matched general population
- d) Historical cancer patients

Answer: c

- 6) Which data quality dimension is measured by re-abstraction audits?
- a) Timeliness
 - b) Completeness
 - c) Accuracy
 - d) Consistency

Answer: c

Part 2: Case Definition Application

7) Scenario: A patient had invasive ductal carcinoma (8500/3) of the left breast (C50.9) in 2022. In 2025, they present with lobular carcinoma (8520/3) in the right breast (C50.2).

Should this be counted as a new primary? (Yes/No)

Answer: Yes, different topography (C50.2 vs C50.9) AND different morphology (8520 vs 8500) per multiple primary rules.

- 8) What would be the diagnosis date for the new case?

Answer: The date of first definitive diagnosis for the new primary (typically the pathology date for the lobular carcinoma).

Part 3: Data Quality Analysis

9) Scenario: Your registry's data shows a recent 20% increase in late-stage lung cancer in a specific rural county.

What two data quality dimensions must you verify before acting on this finding?

Answer: Completeness (case capture) and Accuracy (correct staging).

- 10) What specific checks would you perform for each dimension?

Answer: Completeness: compare to external sources (facility lists, pathology feeds, mortality linkage).

Accuracy: perform targeted re-abstraction audits focusing on stage assignment with NAACCR edit review.

Part 4: Workflow & Security

11) Draw a 6-step surveillance workflow from case finding to public reporting, labeling two key QC touchpoints.

Answer (one acceptable sequence):

Case Finding → Eligibility Screening → Abstraction → Quality Checks → Submission → Public Reporting. QC touchpoints at Abstraction (edit checks) and Pre-submission (re-abstraction audit).

12) List two essential security safeguards for protecting identified surveillance data.

Answer: Any two of:

Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

Encrypted transport/storage (VPN/SFTP)

Audit logs; Data Use Agreements (DUAs).
